

Section B: Understanding social inequalities

Within this section learners will have the opportunity to develop knowledge and understanding of contemporary patterns and trends of social inequality. Learners are able to engage in theoretical debate, explore conceptual issues and develop skills of analysis and evaluation of sociological research and evidence.

Key questions	Content	Learners should:
1. What are the main patterns and trends in social inequality and difference?	Social inequality and difference in relation to: • social class • gender • ethnicity • age	consider the main patterns and trends in relation to work and employment. consider evidence of social inequalities from a range of areas of social life. consider how social inequalities affect life chances.
2. How can patterns and trends in social inequality and difference be explained?	The main sociological explanations of social inequality and difference: • functionalism • Marxism • Weberian • feminism • New Right	have an understanding of the distinctive concepts and ideas associated with each theory.